

Judge faces Trump’s ire and now a big decision

Boasberg weighs holding U.S. officials in contempt over migrant flights

BY ANN E. MARIMOW AND SPENCER S. HSU

During President Donald Trump’s first weeks back in office, Judge James E. Boasberg watched the president and his allies attack other federal judges for halting some of the administration’s most far-reaching initiatives.

His turn came on a Saturday in mid-March.

At an emergency hearing, Boasberg temporarily blocked the administration from deporting alleged gang members to El Salvador without due process. Trump and his allies soon began calling for the judge’s impeachment. Online influencers, Republican lawmakers and the White House spokeswoman joined the attacks, drawing warnings from constitutional scholars about the need to respect the independence of the legal system.

Boasberg’s next decision may be one of his most fraught: whether to begin proceedings to potentially hold Trump officials in contempt for defying one of his orders in the deportation case.

It will be a pivotal moment for the longtime jurist — and the courthouse where he is now the chief judge. Both are venerable institutions in the nation’s capital that have played central roles in national security and presidential scandals for decades. Boasberg, 62, has a history of bipartisan support and friendships across the ideological spectrum, including with Supreme Court Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh, a Trump nominee who was Boasberg’s housemate at Yale Law School.

In court Thursday, the judge

SEE JUDGE ON A7

Law firms: Over 500 denounce punishments from Trump. **A7**



CHET STRANGE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A beloved skier, an audacious jump — and the grief left in its aftermath

BY ROMAN STUBBS IN BLACK HAWK, COLO.

The night before he would try to ski jump over a busy three-lane highway in the Colorado high country, Dallas LeBeau sat down with his parents for dinner in their log cabin home. Valerie and Jason served grilled cheese and soup to their 21-year-old son, and as in the months before, the conversation quickly turned to the jump. Dallas announced that he was going to go for it the next day. His parents stopped eating and stared at him.

“Have you done the math?” Valerie asked him, even though she believed he probably didn’t know how to compute the required speed and lift needed to clear a 40-foot stretch of pavement. He planned to do it on pure instinct.

“Mom, if anything, I’m going to overshoot the landing,” Dallas said. “Maybe you should wait,” his



ZIGGY AVJEAN

Dallas LeBeau’s plan was to perform a double backflip above a stretch of highway at Colorado’s Berthoud Pass as three friends filmed. “Everybody thinks I’m going to get hurt,” he told one friend. “I’m going to be fine.”

father said.

Dallas was a thrill-seeker who loved to put himself in danger, but he usually took measured risks. This didn’t feel like a measured risk, especially in April with the snowpack melting, although most people who knew Dallas didn’t doubt he could pull it off. When Valerie and Jason looked into his eyes that night, they saw a free spirit but also the reflection of what the ski industry had become for many young athletes like their son: an expensive, relentless chase to prove themselves in a social-media-driven world, where skiers often were emboldened to push their limits for the sake of views and clout.

Dallas had worked for years to make it to a top professional tour in skiing, only to stall in the standings last winter. He wasn’t getting younger.

SEE SKI JUMP ON A10

Deportation dragnet is ensnaring U.S. citizens

BY MARÍA LUISA PAÚL

For one man, it happened when he stepped out of a Chicago pizza shop after an afternoon of job hunting. For a 10-year-old girl and her siblings, it began at a Border Patrol checkpoint in South Texas as their family rushed to the hospital. For a man in Virginia, it started with immigration agents surrounding his truck, guns in hand.

All those people are U.S. citizens who were detained, deported or otherwise swept up in immigration enforcement actions under the Trump administration’s intensifying crackdown.

Although wrongful detentions and deportations of U.S. citizens aren’t unheard-of, recent news reports of at least seven alleged cases have alarmed attorneys, civil rights advocates and immigration scholars who say they reveal the dangers of a system accelerating with few safeguards. As the Trump administration pushes for mass deportations, expands federal enforcement and shutters

SEE ICE ON A8

ICE: Detainee who came to give his brother a kidney to be released. **A9**



I’m a disaster reporter.

But I was not prepared to watch my city burn.

BY BRIANNA SACKS

I should have known better. I have seen what wildfire storms can do to cities and entire towns: Santa Rosa, Paradise, Redding, Malibu, Berry Creek, Greenville, Lahaina. As a climate disaster reporter, I know how quickly special places disappear. I routinely walk through their leveled remains.

I grew up in Malibu, the so-called wildfire capital of North America, which some say should just be allowed to burn. Every fall, it seemed, we’d look up at an anxiety-inducing orange sky, wondering if this was it. I remember as a 6-year-old stuffing my toys in the one black plastic bag

SEE WILDFIRES ON A4

MATT HUYNH/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

States struggle to adjust as Trump targets FEMA

Shifting disaster funding away from the federal agency may cause chaos

BY ANNA PHILLIPS, JAKE SPRING, KEVIN CROWE AND DAN DIAMOND

Torrential rain fell on Eastern Kentucky in July 2022, turning creeks into rivers that roared through the valleys and hollows, wrecking hundreds of homes and killing 45 people. Since then, the state has been trapped in a cycle of seemingly never-ending disasters, exhausting storm-weary residents in impoverished small towns.

“Our families are hurting and suffering, and our businesses are being hit and hit again,” said Kristin Walker Collins, chief executive of the nonprofit Foundation for Appalachian Kentucky.

During Donald Trump’s first presidency, the Federal Emergency Management Agency launched a program to break this cycle, awarding billions of dollars to states to repair levees, elevate flood-prone homes and shore up drinking water systems. The program was built on research showing it is many times less expensive

to protect against future damage from natural disasters than to pay for repairs and rebuilding afterward. Kentucky received more than \$7 million for hazard mitigation projects and upgrading power transmission lines.

FEMA is now canceling plans to award these grants for the 2024 fiscal year, according to an internal memo reviewed by The Washington Post. As Trump’s second administration looks to slash federal spending, money given to states by the federal government after disasters strike could also be in jeopardy. The president has said he wants to eliminate FEMA and shift responsibility for disaster response to the states — which experts said are unprepared to respond to catastrophic disasters without federal assistance.

The preparedness grant program, known as Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities, had made more than \$5 billion available since 2020 to help local projects that reduce the impact of disasters. The agency plans to review earlier grants and claw back funding for those that have not yet been paid out, the memo said.

A FEMA spokeswoman said the

SEE FEMA ON A12

EPA grants: Rural communities reel after over \$1 billion in cuts. **A13**

BOOK WORLD

“Fight” is a scooplet on the 2024 election but falls short on its stakes.

ARTS & STYLE

“The Handmaid’s Tale,” in its final season, is ready for the revolution.



WINTER ALL-MET

Our Athletes of the Year. Shown is Sydney Sutton, Bullis, girls’ indoor track.

BUSINESS

See which cocktails and wines could get pricier with Trump’s new tariffs.



METRO

Thousands gather in D.C. as protesters rally across the U.S. against Trump.

TRAVEL

This Texas town, where bluebonnets are king, draws big spring crowds.

COMICS.....INSERT
OBTUARIES.....C5
OPINION PAGES.....A22
WORLD NEWS.....A18

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post / Year 148, No. 54178

